of rRNA ranges from100-600 nucleotides. rRNA molecules have a secondary structure. Intra-strand base pairing between complementary bases often generate double helical segments or loops.

Functions

1. They are required for the formation of ribosomes.
2. They are involved in the initiation of protein synthesis.

Apart from these RNAs, there are also a heterogenous group of RNAs present in the nucleus called as hnRNA and small non-coding RNAs of approximately 22 nucleotide length called as micro RNA or miRNAs.

7.9 Differences between DNA and RNA

S. No.	DNA	RNA
1	Sugar moiety is Deoxy ribose	Sugar moiety is Ribose
2	The bases present are Adenine, Thymine, Guanine and Cytosine. Uracil is not present.	The bases present are Adenine, Uracil, Guanine and Cytosine. Thymine is rarely present.
3	Double stranded molecules	Single stranded molecules
4	Obeys Chargaff's rule	Does not obey Chargaff's rule
5	Bases are not modified	Bases are modified
6	It is stable and not hydrolysed easily by alkalis	It is unstable and hydrolysed easily by alkalis
7	DNA content is constant in all the cells except during cell division	Varies from cell to cell
8	The life time of DNA is comparatively high.	RNA is short lived.
9	No natural DNA is catalytic	RNA can be catalytic
10	Present in the nucleus, mitochondria and chloroplast	Present in the nucleus, mitochondria, nucleolus, ribosomes and cytosol.

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